

“India has the third largest higher-education system in the world, next to China and the US. The government spending on education is close to 4.5 per cent of the GDP. It is estimated that during 2010-15, more than 90 million youths will enter the working-age population. With precisely tuned products, educational and hobby kits market can grab a large share of the technical education sector.” —Mani Lal Gala, managing director, Vegakits

the business of product development, Indian companies are likely to miss the exponential revenue growth associated with successful products.”

Venkat says, “Most of the educator kits developed in India are not capable of testing mixed signals, advanced embedded designs, memory designs, high-speed serial buses, digital RF, etc and have very basic and analogue test capabilities that don’t meet the advanced industry standards. The market is vast and opportunities lie ahead for innovating new, low-cost products for budget-conscious users and enhancements in low-profile products so that they fit multiple design and application testing solutions.”

Considering that the cost associated with the upgradation process can be a deterrent for large-scale adoption of these solutions, Joshi says, “It is not that the funds are not available. The only requirement is that



“There is a huge gap between the industry need for practically trained manpower and corresponding technical students available in India. The educational and hobby kits industry can play a very effective role in bridging this gap.” —Chatanya Sahu, chief marketing officer, Thinnkware

“The educational and hobby kits providers should focus on curriculum that relates to business verticals in the industry and help students to become subject-matter experts.” —Gautam Awasthi, GM-marketing, Electronic Measurement Group, Agilent Technologies

the management of privately managed colleges, which constitute over 75 per cent of the total colleges, should wake up to the fact that quality improvement is the key to compete.”

Success mantra

On the operations front, most players have adopted a combination of cost leadership and differentiation strategies. Regardless of the size and type of the business, they usually prefer to follow the technology trend.

Deshpande banks on the increasing technical awareness of the education community. He informs, “We have experienced a rise in the technical awareness of

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